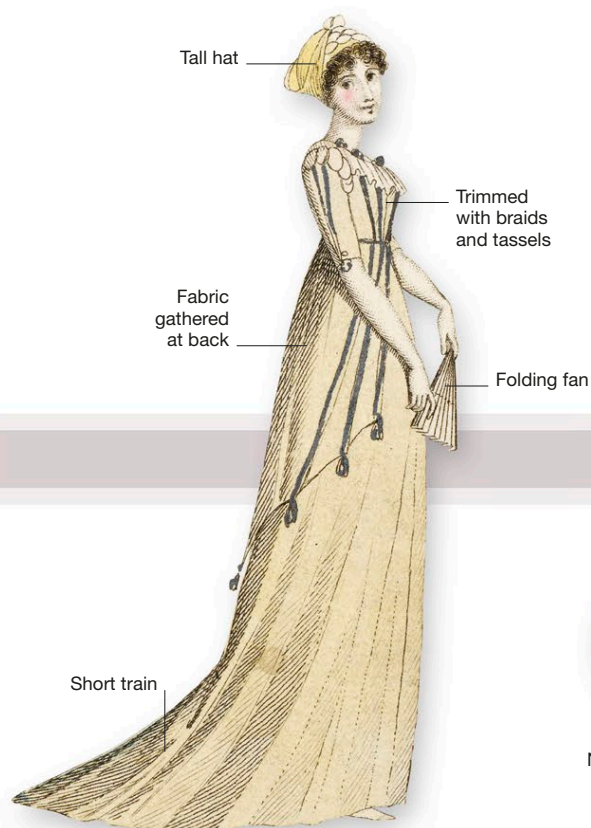




Afternoon dress The vertical braids with tiny tassels on this columnar dress emphasize its slender lines. It has elbow-length sleeves and a train, and is worn with a relatively simple, tall hat. Pale colours such as this lemon tint were favoured.



Stronger hues Colours became stronger by 1809, and this green dress is trimmed with bright red ribbon. There is also a contrasting embroidered hem, though the net or lace spencer and overskirt are white.

GETTING DRESSED

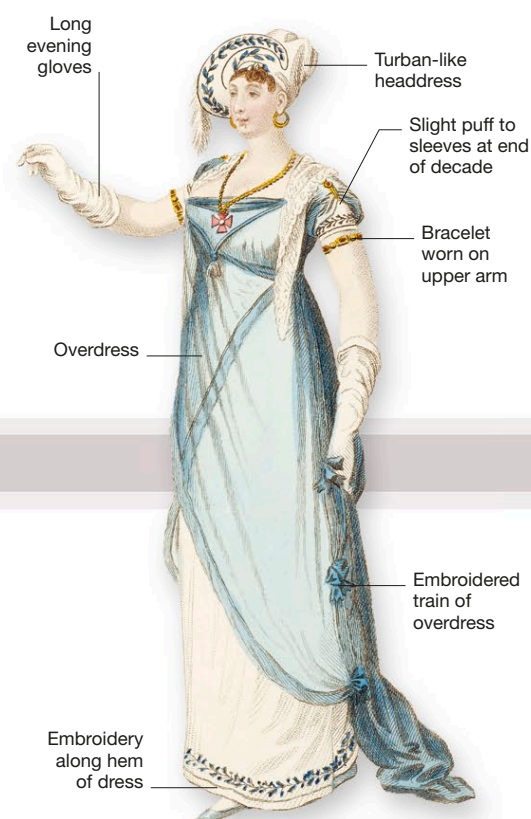


A woman of substance required a lady's maid to help her dress, particularly to get her into her corset. In this period corsets were long line and unboned, and worn over a linen shift called a chemise, drawers – of linen, cotton, or stockinette – and stockings with decorative embroidery. The maid would then assist with the sleeveless dress, which was filmy and clinging, and fasten jewellery as required before helping to curl and pin her mistress's hair under a bonnet or a bandeau trimmed with feathers.



1809

Pelisse For walking in springtime, a pelisse coat, such as this full-length sleeved version in figured silk, could be worn. The extravagant fringed parasol is pagoda-shaped. The waistline on the dress is now a little lower.



Gauze for evening This overdress retains its train, an indicator of eveningwear. It covers an embroidered cotton gown. There is more decoration from the exotic headdress, pendant, and bracelets.